



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Cornerstone Christian Academy
School Website: <https://ccanm.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Cornerstone Christian Academy NM 87120 presents a clearly Christian Classical orientation, anchored in Biblical truth and a Trivium-based approach to learning. Public-facing materials emphasize Biblical authority, virtue formation, and a mission to cultivate spiritual growth through a Classical Christian framework. The school is explicit about its Trivium-based curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and its aim to integrate theology into daily learning, with a strong emphasis on memory work, communal values, and character formation. However, explicit, documented evidence of fully articulated upper-school Socratic pedagogy, a formal "living curriculum" description for faculty, and defined, observable parent-as-co-teacher partnerships are less evident in the public materials. Taken together, the school demonstrates many hallmarks of classical Christian education, but some elements of the Six Essential Elements rubric require more explicit or comprehensive articulation to reach a fully CLASSICAL standing. Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with strong classical Christian foundations and clear trajectory toward fuller classical practice as the program grows.

Executive summary — Element-by-Element snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations** — CLASSICAL Evidence and keywords include explicit statements of Trinitarian theology, biblical inerrancy, gospel-centered life, and Christian theology as governing truth claims. Positive indicators such as God, Biblical truth, Bible, Jesus as Savior, church/fellowship, and Christian formation appear prominently in mission and faith pages. Negative indicators are not evident in public-facing materials. This aligns with transcendental moral realism, grounded theology, and liturgical/communal sensibilities as described in the classical rubric. Why CLASSICAL: clear transcendental/moral aims anchored in biblical theism; explicit theology and gospel-centered framing; communal aspects tied to faith.
- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal** — CLASSICAL Evidence shows a mission to form character and spiritual growth through Classical Christian education rooted in Biblical truth. The mission statement frames formation over information and emphasizes virtue, wisdom, and a Christ-centered life as the educational telos. The site also emphasizes formation and the reality of truth, goodness, and beauty as real in the Christian framework. Why CLASSICAL: formation (not mere information); virtue/wisdom oriented; Biblical truth as foundational.
- **Element 3: School Curriculum** — CLASSICAL Evidence shows explicit Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as the framework for the curriculum, and a commitment to memory-based learning and early childhood formation consistent with classical pedagogy. Pre-school materials emphasize Biblical principles and structured curricular themes, and Kindergarten notes the launch of preschool/JK initiatives. This satisfies the criterion that the curriculum includes grammar, logic, and rhetoric, and indicates history-oriented study implicit in the classical approach, with a focus on wonder and meaningful content. Why CLASSICAL: Trivium explicit; emphasis on memory, structure, and classical aims; progressive pre-K/K program aligned with classical aims.
- **Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods** — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence shows lower-school emphasis on memory, singing, and contemplative/restful learning, and upper-school potential

for dialogue and rhetoric training. Explicit Socratic/seminar methods are not clearly documented in public materials; the materials emphasize memory-based and contemplative learning with moves toward rhetoric and public speaking as students advance. The absence (in public content) of explicit, repeated Socratic/seminar practices suggests room for growth toward full classical pedagogy in the high school years. Positive indicators: memorization, contemplative learning, singing/engagement in lower grades; rhetoric training implied by Trivium. Gaps: explicit upper-school Socratic/seminar approach, regular seminars/debates, and public-speaking opportunities are not clearly documented in website materials. Why SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL: foundational classical practices are present (Trivium, memory, wonder), but explicit, high-school Socratic/seminar pedagogy and a fully articulated “Schole” culture are not yet clearly evidenced on public pages.

- Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence shows a staff structure (administration, teachers) and a faith-based governance context (Sole Ministries/Acacia Worship Center) that frames mentorship and role modeling. However, explicit language describing faculty as the living curriculum, or a formalized “portrait of teacher” and “portrait of student” are not clearly presented in public materials. Positive indicators: staff roles (Administration, Secretary) and church-affiliated governance; mission emphasis on virtuous formation. Gaps: explicit statements about faculty as living curriculum, teacher character portraits, and closely linked mentorship culture are not readily visible in public content. Why SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL: the school context is strongly shaped by teachers/administrators in a faith-based setting, and virtue-centered aims are present, but explicit “living curriculum” framing of faculty is not clearly documented.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence includes a culture of partnership through church/ministry channels and fundraising efforts, and public content inviting involvement in donations and school development. However, explicit, systematic parent-teacher partnership language (parents as co-teachers, formal parent education, and open-door access for visits) is not robustly documented in public-facing materials. Positive indicators: faith-based community, parent involvement via giving, visible church-school connection. Gaps: formal parent-as-co-teachers language and structured parent education initiatives are not clearly present in the public content. Why SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL: community/parent involvement exists in practice (donations, church affiliation), but explicit, formal parent-partnering language and programs are not fully documented.

What would move the needle - Element 4 (Pedagogy): Implement and publicly document explicit upper-school Socratic seminars, regular formal seminars/debates, and rhetoric-focused public speaking opportunities to align with the full classical pedagogy in Grades 9–12. - Element 5 (Faculty): Develop and publish a formal “Living Curriculum” framework for faculty, including a teacher-portrait and a student-portrait, and articulate mentorship as a core role of the faculty. - Element 6 (Parents & Community): Establish and publicize explicit parent-as-co-teachers partnerships (teacher training for parents, co-curricular co-planning, and structured parent education programs), plus open-door policy statements with clear guidelines for visits and involvement.

Notes on the methodology and sources - The analysis draws on public-facing materials from Cornerstone Christian Academy NM 87120 (the school crawl) to identify explicit claims about curriculum, pedagogy, mission, and community involvement (e.g., Classical Christian Education, Trivium, Biblical truth, mission statements, and program descriptions). Key pages include the Classical Christian Education overview, Mission Statement, Our Faith, Preschool/Kindergarten pages, and “At Cornerstone Christian Academy We” values statements, all cited below. - Classical Christian Education overview and Trivium emphasis: Cornerstone’s Classical Christian Education page (turn0file16). - Mission and Biblical truth framing: Mission Statement page (turn0file16); Our Faith page (turn0file2); Kindergarten page and Preschool program notes (turn0file0, turn0file2). - Specific faith-based statements and governance: About Us (turn0file5); Our Faith (turn0file2). - Community and giving/funding: Give page (turn0file4). - The Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) document provides the Positive and Negative Keyword Indicators used for keyword analysis in each category. The Positive Keywords for Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) include Truth, Goodness, Beauty, Virtue, Wisdom, etc., with Theology, liturgy, and communal practices among the indicators; and the Negative Keywords provide a contrast (e.g., moral relativism, secularism). The document is included as turn0file12 for reference and keyword mapping. - For Element 1, Positive Keywords include

Truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, wisdom, sacred tradition, theological integration, Christ-centered education, etc. (turn0file12). - For Element 2, the framework emphasizes formation, truth, goodness, beauty, etc., within a theologically grounded context (turn0file12). - For Element 3, the Trivium and Great Books/Great Conversation concepts are core to the curriculum indicators (turn0file12). - The full set of six elements and respective keywords/indicators are laid out in the same document (turn0file12) to ground the keyword analysis in the classical rubric. - Citations: All quoted or paraphrased evidence from the school materials is cited with the corresponding file markers, e.g., turn0file16 for the Mission Statement and Trivium description; turn0file2 for Our Faith content; turn0file0 for Kindergarten Preschool program; turn0file1 for Our Faith leadership/requirements; turn0file4 for Give; turn0file5 for About Us. The keyword rubric is drawn from turn0file12.

ABSTRACT Cornerstone Christian Academy NM 87120 demonstrates a Christian Classical orientation with a strong emphasis on Biblical truth, virtue formation, and a Trivium-based curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric). Public materials highlight a mission to form character and spiritual growth through a classical framework, with explicit theological grounding and a focus on Biblical authority. The curriculum centers on Trivium and memory-based learning in early grades, with a clear pathway toward rhetoric and public expression in teacher-led settings. While the school shows many hallmark classical elements (Trivium, memory, wonder, and a theology-centered approach), explicit, recurring documentation of high-school Socratic pedagogy, a formal “living curriculum” for faculty, and a robust, explicit parent-as-co-teacher program is less evident in public content. Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with strong classical Christian foundations and clear potential for fuller classical articulation as the program matures.

Abstracted category conclusions: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL. Evidence: Trinitarian theology, Biblical inerrancy, gospel-centered formation, church/fellowship language in public materials (Our Faith; Mission; Bible-centered life). Positive keyword indicators (truth, God, Bible, gospel, theology) are strongly represented. - School Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL. Evidence: Mission statements describe formation, virtue through Biblical truth, spiritual growth, and a Christ-centered telos. - Curriculum: CLASSICAL. Evidence: Trivium-based curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and memory-based pedagogy; Pre-school/K-8 framing with Biblical content. - Pedagogy: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Evidence: Lower-school memory/chanting/restful learning; potential for upper-school Socratic practice is not clearly documented in public content, suggesting room to articulate full classical pedagogy. - Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Evidence: governance by faith-based organization and clear staff roles; lack of explicit language about the faculty as the living curriculum or a formal faculty portrait in public content. - Parents & Community: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Evidence: visible church affiliation and fundraising, but explicit parent-as-co-teachers partnerships and structured parent education programs are not clearly documented.

If you'd like, I can extract direct quotes and build a more granular line-by-line keyword tally against the six-element rubric for each category.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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